

The Unmarked Grave.

Well up into one corner of a small cemetery in the town of H—, may be seen by the observing rambler, a lonely, unmarked grave. The plot of ground in which the grave is situated is no longer used as a burial place; the site being considered to remote from the main country road, hence to unostentatious for resting place of the dead, in these times of progress and display.

Briars and rank weeds have long since usurped the earth that erst was considered sacred. The fence that surrounds it, that once might have been deemed a model, no longer affords protection against the inroads of sheep and kine, that being wont to feed in the neighboring pastures, often invade the place to browse, making paths here and there in the fibrous gleb with their hard horny hoofs.

Woodchucks and rabbits have in places burrowed in startling proximity to where should rest undisturbed the remains of the departed. Here and there excavations show that disinterments have taken place, either by the hands of friends or vandals, perhaps both, as the latter could here ply their unholy vocation unmolested, the spot is so seldom visited.

A few common granite slabs with simple inscriptions graven upon them, giving the name and date of birth and death of the sleepers beneath may be seen standing, though some have tumbled down and a few are in a toppling condition.

My ramblings had often led me by the plot and I had sometimes paused and leaned over the dilapidated board fence with boyish curiosity to read the names carved on the moss grown tablets; while passing I had noticed the unmarked grave in the corner, and I had wondered why it should be thus, for it was evidently that of an adult.

Late one afternoon in June, a few years after I had become cognizant of the existence of the neglected grave, as I was about to cross near the place, I discovered an old man treading upon the grass and looking toward the neglected grave. I asked him for information from him, concerning the unknown sleeper in the corner of the burial plot; accordingly I went up to him and after exchanging the customary civilities, I asked him if he could remember the person buried in the place designated when living, and if so, he would be kind enough to tell me of some of the circumstances connected therewith.

The old man stood his saw against the fence he had been truncating, made an attempt at straightening up, rubbed the back of his hand across his eyes, as if to clear the blur from them, stood for a moment as if in deep thought, glanced twice or thrice in the direction of the plot indicated and replied approximately as follows:—

Remember her, why yes; the mother of eleven children lies buried there. All of whom are yet living and are residents of the town, with one or two exceptions. I knew the mother well while in life, she was a perfect angel in temperament, and a saint indeed. She was possessed of a stoical endurance and resignation; though the mother of so large a family she died before her time.

I know it must seem strange to you, that no stone is erected over her resting place, that where carefully tended flowers should now be blooming and fragrant grasses waving in the June wind, there should be instead wildness and decay, yet so it is; the dead are too soon forgotten and allowed to rest in unknown graves through negligence. She is too soon forgotten to all outward appearance, even by friends and relatives, though I have often wondered that that so little consideration should be shown on the part of children for their mother, dead.

Many is the time—God knows—when I occupy of yonder unmarked grave I carried her children in succession to her arms, while attending to her household duties; has carried them and looked over them when they were ill; has worked and worried herself to exhaustion to provide for their many wants and comforts when well and has she apparently forgotten, and none of those who so often have drawn nourishment from the breast, that is since who owe their very being to her, it seems with appreciation enough to even an unrequited visit to her grave to place there a simple bouquet of flowers as a slight token of remembrance and respect, when in this glorious month flowers exist in such profusion,

aye, bloom wild and lovely, even in sight of her lonesome resting place.

The most wonderful part of such a circumstance is, (here the old man eyed me with an intense expression of cynicism,) that nearly all of that mother's children are professedly Christians. Many of them to my certain knowledge conduct devotional services at their own domiciles.

Do not misunderstand me; a man of my age finds it to his advantage to speak the truth, God forbid that I shall ever be found speaking in disparagement of the Heaven born blessings of true Christianity. I have often involuntarily found myself trying to picture in my unsophisticated way, how it will look on the morn of the Resurrection, to see a mother vainly trying to gain recognition from her children, calling them by name and attempting to caress them, as the idea begins to dawn upon their obliterated minds that they were once born of a mother.

Young man, life is opening fourth to you with all its charms of observation. God grant you many joys and few ills, you have much to learn. There are very many things that it would be impossible for me to explain to you, did I choose to try, things that time alone and experience can reveal to you.

But I admonish you, let nothing of note escape your observation, ever be on the alert to gain some new facts.

Facts, young man, are particles of grit that go to compose the grindstone of experience; though the minds naturally recoil from contact with this stone it is only by a constant application to it; that its possessor is enabled after many years to pose as a man of much wisdom, and to go down to the grave esteemed amid weeping and universal sadness.

I am an old man; I have already lived out more than the allotted time given, and according to precedent will soon occupy a place directly by the side of the lonely sleeper in yonder corner.

My worldly wealth is not great and I have no home on earth that I can call my own. I wish that I may be permitted a decent burial when I die and wish no more. Don't you see, young man, let me tell you that that grave there is not the only mother's grave that is neglected. The more shame for the money. I could tell you more of the lonely sleeper yonder and her connections but it would not be to your purpose. Enough to know that she was a kind, tender-hearted, true mother, that she rests in a neglected grave and that avarice will breed disrespect, snap the ties of friendship, freedom, ingratitude, and serve to obliterate memories that should be perpetuated as sacred.

I have said enough, perhaps more than I ought, but my words have emanated from a source of conviction, established by a long life of careful observation. It is now time for me to cease labor, adieu.

I grasped his toil word hand instinctively, and bade him a regretful farewell and watched him plod out of sight over a knoll to the northward.

The sun had just sunk behind the western hills, and his last beams were bathing reflective points on the far-away eastern hill-sides in floods of incandescent light, when I set my face in the direction of my home to the southward.

The faintest of zephyrs wafted the delicate perfumes of wild flowers to the senses, and a robin-red-breast sat on a defending board, opposite the grave of a forgotten mother and carolled lays of exquisite sweetness, straining his throat exultingly nigh to bursting in his career of song.

OTHO. DILDO.

WHAT WE'RE COMING TO.

When an editor makes a mistake in his paper, all the world sees it and calls him a fool. When a private citizen makes a mistake, nobody knows it except a few friends, and they come around and ask the editor to keep it out of the paper. When a private citizen dies the editor is asked to write up his good qualities and leave the bad out. When the editor dies, the private citizen says: "Now that damned liar will get his deserts."

A FEARFUL POSSIBILITY.

Physician—There is grave danger, Mrs. Mulcahey, of the cholera reaching this country this summer, and I want to impress upon your mind the importance of cleanliness. Your premises are in bad condition and your children unnecessarily filthy, while you yourself are not much better. I would advise a thorough cleaning all around. Mrs. Mulcahey, anxiously—Yes, sir; but what if the cholera shouldn't come after all, doctor, what then.

THEY ALL DO IT.

Hefelstein keeps a clothing store, (just around the corner, ~~at~~) and the other day a stranger stopped to look at a coat hanging by the door. Hefelstein rushed out.

"Dot ish a splendid artsegle, mine front, and so sheep as noddink," he said with a smile.

"I reckon I'll go inside and take a look," said the stranger.

"Dot ish right. Valk right in und look ofer der endire sthook. Dar's noddink in der town like dose gools!"

The visitor went in and after looking around awhile, remarked:

"I was in here some time ago but the place seemed different than it does now."

Hefelstein began to snifle.

"Ah, mine front, I thought I knew ven you talk by der sthore. Dot time you vas here, mine brother vas alive, und dersthere vas twice as pig, but he ish ted now, und der sthore is cut down von halluf."

"It was your brother, I reckon that I knew. What's the price of this coat," he asked, holding up the garment.

"Vat ish your name mine front?" sniffed Hefelstein, taking his arm.

"Wiggins sir, Mr. Wiggins, of Kentucky."

"Ah, my dear Meester Viggins, I am ferry glad to see you, intect. My poor brodder spokke off you ven he vas tying," and Hefelstein wiped his eyes.

"Indeed," replied Mr. Wiggins in astonishment.

"Yes, Mr. Viggins, ven Moses vas trawing his laast breat, he calt me to his site, und vispering ferry low, he said, 'Mine brudder, I'm koin' away from der cloddin' peezness for efer, und I put my ear kweite close to his hat and caught dese vorts, 'dot rekkest my brudder, is dot ven Meester Viggins, oaf Kentucky comes to der sthore, you vill sell him goots at der ferry lowest brices.' Dose vere his laast vords, Mr. Viggins, und ven I dells you, you can hat dot goat at ten tollar und sixty-five cents, you vill know I'm telling set for shure, und nod fer money false, Mr. Viggins."

Wiggins had to take the coat.

HE OUGHT TO HAVE IT.

A Boston man has applied for a divorce because his wife boils the beef-steak and shakes up the coffee.

"NEIN, NEIN."

A German went into a restaurant the other day, and as he took his seat the waiter came up and bowed politely. "Wie gehts," said the Dutchman, also bowing politely. "Wheat cakes?" said the waiter, mistaking the salutation for an order. "Nein, nein!" said the German. "Nine!" said the waiter, "you'll be lucky if you get three."

CHICKEN THIEVES.

As thieves the negroes in Barbadoes are the most expert, and burglaries are frequent especially in the smaller houses.

A hen roost is it almost impossible to preserve from them, and if they get into one they will sweep it clean. Their mode of proceeding on such occasions is, I am told, as follows: Having obtained an entry, they seize each bird from the perch, put its head under its wing and whirl the unfortunate fowl round and round in the air five or six times. The result of this—as I can testify—is that the bird remains torpid, and apparently lifeless, and is thus easily stowed away in a bag without danger of inconvenient cackling. Nor is it against their betters only that such attacks are directed, for they prey equally upon each other. Every night in Barbadoes is made hideous by the discharge of firearms out of the windows of the shanties as a warning that the inmates are on their guard.

HITS THE NAIL ON THE HEAD

In his sermon on a recent Sunday Henry Ward Beecher remarked: "Fantasism is enthusiasm gone beyond the bounds of reason. But it is a thousand times better than torpidity. I have a great respect for fanatics. I think all the fifty years of the American Bible society and fifty years of the American board of Missionaries for foreign heathen did not amount to so much combined together as an impulse for setting a man free from bondage as John Brown—one single instance of his life and of his desperate, despairing endeavor to rescue the slave." There's a good deal of good solid, sense in those words.

WHY DOES THE BOY WHISTLE.

This problem becomes one of practical interest at once, when we remember that if we can but find the cause of the evil, we can generally find a cure for it. It is certainly worth thoughtful consideration.

If the above question was propounded to a person who had never heard a boy whistle, if we can imagine such a being, he would doubtless answer that the boys whistle because they love music—just as a bird sings. Such an idea, of course never occurs to any one who has ever heard a boy whistle. A philosopher would be more apt to think that the boy whistles because he dislikes the music; that he has an innate antipathy to all harmonious sounds, such as it is well known some other animals have, and that instead of merely trying to escape, like them, from the hated sounds, he delights in offering a continual and public insult to harmony and all its lovers. This theory is also sustained by his well-known admiration for the organ grinders and cornet players. But on more careful consideration it is evident that this idea is too absurd for the mind of the boy, and he certainly never rests long enough from his whistling to think of so much.

It has been suggested that perhaps he whistles because he thinks it is a manly vice, something like smoking and drinking, only cheaper. But the fact is, men seldom whistle, except in moderation, and the boy is so much farther than the man in this respect that it is as absurd to suppose that the younger imitates the elder as it would be to assert that Irving Hall copies its political methods from Tammany.

A plausible theory is that the boy whistles to attract attention to himself. It is true that the boy is ordinarily very anxious to be prominent, whether for the sake of a new intimation gold snuff-pipe or merely a cigarette, and we might not be satisfied with this explanation if it was only one boy that whistled, or even a few boys, but when all boys whistle, (and well-known shrill and general whistles of some popular tune becomes only a signal of warning to drive all within range from the vicinity.

The last and best suggestion is that the boy whistles simply because he loves noise, and he will go a long way to hear a brass band or even a cabinet organ. But it is also evident that noise is not his only object in whistling, for there are too many other means of making a noise within his reach for which he does not care. The kazoo is inexpensive and has great possibilities. Bones should be popular with him. A tin horn is simple and has a very resonant tone. And yet none of them has enjoyed any popularity with him. No, there is something beside the love of noise that impells the boy to whistle. Something which the boy does not know himself. Something which we shall never find out. Something which makes the frogs croak and the ass bray and the buzz.—Life.

KEEPING HIS PROMISE.

A Georgia young man who promised his wife before they were married that if he ever got too poor to have her washing done he would do it himself. He is now fulfilling the promise.

A LONG BRIDGE

The Chinese have finished a bridge across an arm of the China sea at Langang, which is 500 miles long, has 300 arches, 70 feet high and 75 feet apart, with a roadway 70 feet wide, the whole structure being built entirely of stone.

SOME PEOPLE

Can never allow anything to escape them. There was young Algernon Fitzguy, who appeared on the street when the thermometer was 81° in the shade, with a pair of ear muffs adorning the sides of his head. "Hello!" said a friend. "What's the matter? Aren't afraid your ears will be frost bitten are you?" "Oh, na-a-w, not at all thanks. Went to the Thomas concert last night. Don't want any of the harmony to escape, ye know. Deuced clever idea, don't you think so."

MORAL BITTERS.

Misfortunes are moral bitters, which frequently restore the moral tone of the mind, after it has been cloyed and sickened by prosperity.

Who would willingly have others perfect, yet we amend not our own faults.

GEMS.

Nature is commanded by obeying her. Pleasure is the reward of admiration. Habit if not released soon becomes necessity.

The world is undone by looking at things at a distance.

Without steady, hard work it is impossible to excel in anything.

Manner is one of the greatest engines of influence ever given to man.

Hidden virtue is often despised, inasmuch as nothing extols it in our eyes.

Conscience is the voice of the soul, and passions are the voice of the body.

Where men are the most sure and arrogant, they are commonly wrong. Men seldom improve when they copy no other model than themselves.

It is difficult to persuade mankind that the love of virtue, is the love of themselves.

You cannot dream yourself into a good character, you must hammer and forge yourself one.

The way to find out what future duties will be is to do present duty.

The most brilliant qualities become useless when they are not sustained by force of character.

Leisure is sweet to those who have earned it but burdensome to those who get it for nothing.

Seem as you are. When you are simply comfortable don't seem exceedingly happy.

Be loving and you will never want for love, be humble and you will never want for guiding.

We cannot conquer fate and necessity but we can yield to them in such a way as to be greater than if we could.

Nothing can be more foolish than an idea which some parents have that it is not respectable to set their children to work.

A beautiful eye makes silence eloquent; a kind eye makes contradiction an assent; an enraged eye makes beauty deformed.

Memory is the only paradise out of which we cannot be driven away. Indeed, our first parents were not to be deprived of it.

"Honor the old, consult the wise, instruct the young and bear with the foolish."

Opposition is what we want and must have to be good for anything. Hardship is the native soil of manhood and self reliance.

The perfection of conversation is not to play a regular sonata, but, like the Aeolian harp, to await inspiration of the passing breeze.

WEDDED AS A JOKE.

While a party of young people were enjoying a social hour last evening at Durr's restaurant, Philadelphia, the conversation turned on the subject of matrimony, and Fred Martin in a joking way said that he would marry one of the girls present, named Miss Gaffga, if Mr. Zimmerly would marry another young lady named Tehadt. Zimmerly said he was ready to do it to a moment's notice and after a good deal of laughter, Alderman Roessler was called in from the next room to tie the nuptial knot.

Up to that time Martin had never spoken of marriage to Miss Gaffga, and when the good-natured Justice appeared and announced that he was ready to perform then and there, few of those present regard the affair as anything more than a joke; but Martin asserted that he was in earnest, and declared that if Miss Gaffga would accept him he was ready to become her husband.

His companions heartily applauded his sentiment and the applause was renewed when Miss Gaffga, blushing like a June-rose, took her place by his side and indicated her willingness to become his bride. "That looks like business," said the Alderman, adjusting his spectacles. The laughter of the spectators was hushed and the words were spoken that made Martin and Miss Gaffga husband and wife. Miss Gaffga who is a charming brunette, was immediately congratulated by her friends, the girls of the party crowding around and kissing her, while the men shook Martin warmly by the hand and said how glad they were that he had won such a treasure.

Then came Mr. Zimmerly's and Miss Tehadt's turn, but at the last moment the lady declined, and said she wanted to be married by a clergyman. This was something of a disappointment but the party united heartily in the celebrating the impromptu nuptials of Mr. and Mrs. Martin, and kept up the festivities until a late hour.

AN HONEST BOY HUMILIATINGLY TREATED.

They said the train was an hour late, and that information made us feel put out and annoyed. Therefore, when a boy of about 14, poorly clad and having a tramping look came along the platform asking for financial aid, to get down to C—, on the train we were waiting for, it was but natural that one said all replied: "If you want to go to C—, take the dirt road! You look as though you were used to it."

He had no saucy word in reply. When he went and stood in the light of the window, and I saw how he shivered in the cold wind, and how worried and anxious he looked, I grew ashamed of my rough words. I saw two or three others look him over as he had done, and I had no doubt that they felt as I did.

I ought to have walked up to the boy and said: "Here my lad if you really want to go to C—, I'm willing to help you. I'm willing to help you. Take this half-dollar. How that a lad of your age is cold, and ragged, and away from home."

But I didn't. All of a sudden he disappeared. I reasoned that he had gone up the hill to the village, and his pretending to want to go to C—, was all a trick to best honest men. When you reason that way the heart becomes hard pretty fast, and you feel a bit revengeful. We talked the matter over—four or five of us—and the conclusion was the boy would die on the gallows.

Well, the morning train came along after awhile, and it was moving away after a brief stop, when a piercing shriek, followed by sobs and calls, brought us to a stop.

"Somebody's been run over!" called a voice, and in a moment the coaches were emptied.

Yes, somebody had been run over—had a leg cut off above the knee by one of the cruel wheels. Who was it? How did it happen? It was our boy—the lad who was to end his days on the gallows. He had crept under the coach to steal a ride on the tracks. There he was, having only a few moments to live—his lips quivered as twenty men bent down and spoke words of sympathy.

"Who are you?" asked the conductor. "Tim."

"You shouldn't have tried it."

"But I wanted to go to C— so bad! I was up here to find work, but nobody would have me, and yesterday I heard that mother was dead!"

"But anyone would have given you sixty cents to pay your fare."

"Oh, no they wouldn't! I asked lots and lots of men and they said I ought to be in jail. I—I—wanted—!" There we were—the half dozen of us who had repelled him with insult—sprung his young heart still more—sent him to his horrible death under the wheels. We dared not look into his face—we even shunned each other.

If it could only come to pass again—If Heaven would send him back to earth and let him stand before us as he did that cold winter's night.—Detroit Free Press.

SEVENTY-FIVE CENTS IS A HALF-DOLLAR.

There are certain minds on which travel has had effect. Their owners do not come home improved by the advent of the changes of the scene, but so altered that their friends are scarcely able to recognize them. And, indeed they are often unwilling recognize their acquaintances. Some years ago there lived in this village, a blacksmith by the name of Green.

One day a new customer drove, a young man, who was, however, not a stranger to the old gentleman. He had once been called Blodgett, but he had returned from Europe considerably Frenchified.

He wanted a shoe set, and after the job had been completed, took out his purse and inquired:

"Aw—how much is the charwage?"

The reply came short and sharp:

"Half a dollar."

"Half a dollar, haw! a dollar? Weally, I've been out of the country so long that I don't know what a haw! dollar is, you know," he answered, giving the blacksmith a one dollar bill.

The old man stood in amazement. He had never seen this sort of human specimen before. Then thrusting the bill in one pocket, he drew forth a quarter from the other saying as he gave it to the returned traveler:

"I thought every fool knew a half-dollar was seventy-five cents!" and he marched back to his forge.

THE TWO VILLAGES.

Over the river on the hill
Lies a village quiet and still;
All around it the forest trees
Shiver and whisper in the breeze.
Over it, sailing shadows go
Of soaring hawk and screaming crow,
And mountain grasses low and sweet
Grow in the middle of every street.

Over the river under the hill,
Another village lies still;
There I see in the cloudy night
Twinkling stars of household light,
Fires that gleam from the smith's door,
Mists that curl on the river shore,
And in the road no grasses grow
For the wheels that hasten to and fro.

In that village on the hill
Never a sound of smith or mill;
The houses are thatched with grasses and
flowers,
Never a clock to toll the hours;
The marble doors are always shut,
You cannot enter in hall or hut,
All the village lies asleep.

Never a grain to sow or reap,
Never in dreams to moan or sigh,
Silent and idle and low they lie.

In that village under the hill—
When the night is starry and still
Many a weary soul in prayer
Looks to the other village there,
And weeping and sighing longs to go
Up to that home from this below,
Long to sleep in the forest wild
Whither have vanished wife and child,
And hearth praying, this answer fall—
"Patience! This village shall hold you all!"
—Every Other Saturday.

THE SWITCH-TENDER.

FROM THE FRENCH OF C. DE BARR.

A little white house sleeps
among the blossoming apple trees. It
is early morning, and all is light and
freshness. The door opens, a man ap-
pears at the threshold, a smile on his
face and an expectant look in his eyes.
There is a movement behind the trunk
of an apple tree. The man's smile
grows broader, and from the tree, like a
dried, rushes a charming little flaxen-
haired girl, who throws herself with a
burst of laughter into his arms.

"May I take the little one, Celine?"
said the father.

At these words a lovely blonde made
her appearance.

"Again!" she said with a shade of an-
noyance.

"Oh! we share her very fairly," said
the man, with the kindest and most
paternal smile. "If you knew," he re-
sumed, "how quickly the hours pass
when she is down there with me."

"Don't you think I know, when I find
them so long in her absence?"

It was embarrassing. Aimee herself
began to be troubled by this conversa-
tion, and feeling that she could not
please both these beings that she loved
so much, she was ready to cry. Celine
saw it at once and yielded.

"Take her, Laurence, I would rather
have her go than feel badly about it."

The father at these words showed
some feeling.

"No," said he, in his turn, "keep her,
you deserve it; you love her best."

And the discussion began again, but
it was this time a struggle of generosity.
At last the husband took his darling in
his arms, and a smile reappeared on the
child's lips.

Celine looked longingly after them,
and re-entered the house.

One morning, without saying any-
thing to Celine, Laurence took the little
girl's hand to lead her away, when her
mother suddenly appeared.

"What!" she said. "You would take
her without telling me?"

"Don't think that," said Laurence, in
some confusion. "We were in fun—we
were going to hide behind the trees and
see you look for us."

"Oh!" said Celine, doubtfully.

"Listen, Laurence," she continued.
"Aimee grows more restless and trouble-
some every day. It is dangerous to let
her go with you."

"What do you mean?" said the man,
turning pale.

"I mean that I am afraid of your rail-
road, with its trains and locomotives."

"You are very foolish."

"Leave her here. I can hardly breathe
while my little girl is down there. It is
frightful to think of, but she might get
away and be killed."

"Don't talk so, Celine."

"She might run away while you are
at the switch, and if you left it to look
after her, you would fail in your duty,
and might be the cause of a dreadful
disaster."

"Oh, Celine, I beg of you, don't!"
cried Laurence, who shuddered at the
idea.

The young woman did not insist. The
switch-tender gradually recovered him-
self.

"My poor Aimee!" he cried, embrac-
ing the child frantically. "It is too bad,
Celine; it is a shame to frighten me so."

Celine smiled, and the conversation
ended as usual with these words from
Laurence:

"You will come for her at noon."

Little by little their terrors faded
away. Laurence reasoned with himself.

"The child," he said, "is familiar
with the passage of the trains, it is
true, but she is old enough to compre-
hend the danger." And his apprehen-
sions gradually vanished.

One evening, however, when he went
home he found he had been preceded by
the rumor of an accident which had oc-
curred at a neighboring station. A
brakeman had been crushed by an ex-
press train. Celine questioned her hus-
band while they were at supper. "Is it
true that Simon is killed?" she asked.

"No," replied Laurence; "he was in

great danger, but he escaped, thanks to
his wonderful coolness."

"Then he is not dead?" said Celine.

"No; and yet the whole train went
over him. When Simon saw it was too
late to save himself, he lay flat down in
the middle of the track, and when the
train had passed by he got up again
safe and sound. I saw him, and I asked
him how it made him feel. At first, he
said, when the engine went over him, he
was very warm, after that the time
seemed long. That was all. You know
Simon is not easily frightened. He is
ready to go to work again," added Lau-
rence, tranquilly.

But Celine's anxieties were aroused
afresh.

Sometime after that the hours of ser-
vice were changed again and Laurence
took the night section. He could no
longer think of taking Aimee with him.

One evening, however, a poor woman
in the village was taken very ill. The
doctor who came wrote a prescription
and said to the neighbors he found there:
"These medicines can only be
had in the town, and you must not wait
for them. Let one of you go to the rail-
way station, where there is a portable
pharmacy, and ask the station master
on my account for a little laudanum.
That will quiet the pains till you can
have the prescriptions. Which of you
will go?"

"Celine! Celine!" said several voices.

It was certain that the station-master
would not hesitate to give her the medi-
cine.

The young woman thought at first of
leaving Aimee, but, as she had been
particularly restless all day, Celine con-
cluded to take her. They had to pass
Laurence's post to go to the station. He
saw them coming, and as soon as they
were within hearing, began to question
them.

"Old Gertrude is very ill, and I am
going to the station for medicine."

"That's right. But let me have
Aimee; I will keep her till you come
back."

Celine lifted the little girl over the
fence to her father, who took the pre-
cious burden in his arms and returned
with her to his box, before which a
lamp was burning. All around dark-
ness covered the tracks, which crossed
each other in every direction.

It would not take Celine more than
twenty minutes to get to the station and
back. The child was in one of her
most frolicsome moods; she ran sudden-
ly into the garden; Laurence ran laugh-
ing after her.

"You can't catch me," said she.

"Yes, I can."

But the little witch evaded Laurence's
pursuit, leaving laughter behind her.

"Here, here!" she said, and rushed to
the track and began to cross it.

"Don't go there, darling," said her
father. It was very dark—the switch-
tender could hardly see his daughter.

"You can't catch me," repeated the
child.

"Come, come here," said her father.

"Look for me," answered the child.

"Aimee, Aimee, don't play any more.
I shall be angry. Come here."

"Oh! you say that because you can't
catch me."

"Come back, I will give you a cake."

"That isn't true; you haven't one.
You want to make me come back."

"Yes, I don't want you to stay there.
The express train is coming. Be quick."

"Oh! I shan't let you catch me. The
train has gone by."

"There is another."

Instead of replying, the child said:

"Run after me, papa; run."

Laurence saw there was nothing to be
done but to run after her and take her
out of danger. He rushed toward the
place where he heard her voice. It was
dark, and Aimee escaped him still. His
alarm increased. At any instant the
whistle of the on-coming train might be
heard, and Laurence redoubled his ap-
peals. His voice was hoarse with fright.

The fatal moment approached, and still
the child laughed and repeated, "You
can't catch me." Now the whistle
sounded. The lugubrious call paralyzed
the poor man, and he lost his head com-
pletely. The train would have two vic-
tims if he did not regain his composure.

Two victims! It would be a catastro-
phe with incalculable consequences;
for a train was stopping at the station a
little way ahead, and if the express was
not switched off there must inevitably
be a collision. Laurence shook off his
torpor.

"Aimee!" he cried, in thundering
tones.

"Here, papa." And the child con-
tinued to give sharp little calls, which
mingled with the roar of the approach-
ing engine. The instinct of duty, rather
than will, urged Laurence toward the
switch. He seized the instrument which
ought to turn the train. "No," he cried,
"I must save her. Aimee, Aimee!
where are you?" and his eyes sought to
 pierce the darkness. The switch-tender,
with hair on end, thought of throwing
himself before the iron monster. But
one chance remained, that Aimee was
not on the track over which the train
must pass. He looked again, and this
time he saw her—he saw her. She was
there, standing on the very track the
train must take if he altered the switch.

If the iron monster did not take its true
course the child was saved. The train
would go on to crash against the one at
the station. What matter? Aimee
would be alive! All this went through
his head like lightning. There would be
the killed and wounded—twenty families
in despair, but Aimee would be safe and
sound. There would be an inquest; he

would be condemned to prison, dishon-
ored, ruined! But his daughter, his
Aimee, would live and be happy. Ah!
how quickly one can think in such ter-
rible moments!

The train came thundering on, but it
could not be seen on account of a sharp
curve in the road. There was still time
to save Aimee, but the child would not
stir. It seemed to her father that she
waited for the train with an air of de-
fiance.

"Aimee," he repeated, in a voice
strangled by fear—"Aimee, come here;
you will kill me!"

Suddenly the advancing lights of the
engine appeared. The train was upon
him; it was here. The man felt his
whole being shaken. He was bewil-
dered—could see nothing; thought did
not stop, however, but traveled faster
than the train. He recalled in a second
his honorable soldier's life, when he had
sacrificed everything to duty. He saw
in the station the frightful accident he
would have caused, and heard the cries
of the wounded, the last gasps of the
dying. The problem was before him—
his daughter or others? There was no al-
ternative without a miracle. With an
astonishing promptitude the sentiment
of duty became most powerful, and he
seized mechanically the handle of the
iron bar. The stoical soldier at this
moment was uppermost, and effaced the
father. He pushed, hardly knowing
what he did, and the express train
crossed the switch.

On, on it went, and he could see it
passing before the station, going by as
if it were happy to escape a danger, and
disappearing in the darkness. Duty
had been strongest. Stupefied,
staggered, speechless, Laurence was
rooted to the spot, holding still the
cursed handle which had helped him to
kill his child.

"Now," he said, "it is my turn to
die."

The other train was about to pass.
He stepped forward, crossed his arms,
and awaited it. The whistle sounded,
the heavy engine puffed.

Bewildered, thinking of nothing, there
he stood.

But that instant a burst of laughter
sounded behind him. He turned, wild
with hope.

"Oh, naughty papa!—he won't play
with Aimee," said the most beloved of
voices.

The child was clinging to him. Lau-
rence did not seek to know how the
child came there alive. He seized her,
and fled with his treasure into his little
cabin. Then he put her on the ground
before the lamp and looked at her. He
could not bear so much joy, and fell
fainting beside his daughter, who, in her
turn, screamed with terror.

At this moment Celine arrived. She
heard Aimee's voice and hastened her
steps. Then becoming impatient, she
called, "Aimee!" The child ran to
meet her, crying, "Mamma, mamma, I
am frightened!"

"What is the matter?"

"Papa has fallen down."

Celine rushed toward the sentry-box
and found her husband completely in-
sensible stretched on the ground. She
sent for help, and the doctor, who had
not left the village, came and restored
the poor man to consciousness. The
next day when Laurence rose his wife
looked at him with terror. Instead of
his former bright color he exhibited a
corpse-like pallor, which never left him
to the end of his days. Laurence was
forced to tell his wife all. When he had
finished the poor father turned to Aimee
and said: "But, darling, why weren't
you killed?"

"Why," said the child, "I did what
Simon did."—Chicago Inter-Ocean.

Market Day in Harrisburg.

Every Wednesday and Saturday is
market morning. And such a market.
Country knit socks and sorghum mo-
lasses, "smeared case," tallow dips, san-
sage, apple butter, side meat the color
of an oak plank and as hard; beet pick-
les, five cents a saucer; cucumber pick-
les six inches long and three inches
thick, one cent each; corn meal mush,
country hard soap out in irregular size
and sold for what it will fetch, saucer
cheese, sassafras, dried apples, butter-
milk, sweet cider and the hundred and
one products of the dairy and farm, and
over all the sweet and in those days of
conservatory beauties rare perfume of
old fashioned flowers, the direct de-
scendants of hyacinths, cowslips, violets
and blue bells that bloomed along the
banks of the broad river.

In addition to the regular market
house Market street is transformed into
one vast vegetable mart on these morn-
ings. As early as one a. m. the Dan-
phin county Dutch farmers drive into
town. An ancient tin lantern, with
perforated sides and three inches of
candle inside, sheds a very faint light,
by which they unharness and get into
position for the day's business. Their
vehicles, usually one horse, are backed
up to the curb, the end gate dropped,
two boards and as many trawls set out
on the pavement, and on and over this
the business is done. Business opens
about half-past four and is over at half-
past eight a. m. From half-past five to
half-past seven the market is crowded.
By nine o'clock the street and market
place is deserted, and nothing but vege-
table refuse is left.—Pittsburg Dis-
patch.

A FEMALE CRUSOE.

THE SINGULAR STORY OF THE LOST
WOMAN OF SAN NICOLAS.

Found on an Island Where She had Re-
mained for Sixteen Years.

San Nicolas Island is one of the clus-
ter about the Bay of Santa Barbara,
California. Here for eighteen years
lived the "Lost Woman of San Nicolas."
The story, as told in the Rochester
Democrat, by a San Francisco corre-
spondent, is a strange one. In 1835
the Alaska Indians were removed from
the island by the Government. One
"white Indian woman" went ashore for
her child, and was left behind. No at-
tempt was made to rescue her, but six-
teen years later a casual visitor to the
island discovered footprints of a woman
and evidences of her life. She could
not, however, be discovered then or in
the following year. "The Catholic
fathers of the 'Old Mission,' the fore-
most in every good word and work,
offered a reward to any one who would
find the lost woman, and a third effort
was made in 1853 to discover the prodi-
gial about whom there was such a mys-
tery, and in whom the world of this
coast was beginning to take an interest.
Fresh tracks of the woman were found.
They belonged to very small feet, and
were like those that were seen in the
first attempt to find the woman. Huts
made of whale ribs and covered with
brush were discovered. At length an
object was seen in the distance that ap-
peared to be moving. Going toward it,
they saw the woman that for eighteen
years had reigned Queen of San Nicolas,
her subjects being the wild animals,
her robe a dress of bird-skins she had
made, and her throne the hut she had
built. She was seated in an inclosure,
so that only her head and shoulders
could be seen. Two or three dogs were
about her, that disappeared at the com-
mand of their sovereign. She was
seated on some grass that covered the
ground and served her as a bed. Her
dress was neatly made of bird-skins, ex-
tending to her ankles, the feathers of
which pointed downward. Her head
was covered with a thick mat of yellow-
ish-brown hair, and her shoulders were
bare. She was occupied in stripping
blubber from a piece of sealskin which
she held across her knee, and using for
that purpose a knife made of an iron
hoop. In her hut was a fire, beside
which she sat talking to herself, and oc-
casionally shading her eyes with her
hand, looked at the men that were in
search of her. She received them with
much courtesy, bowing and smiling,
and showing that this lost child of nature
had much of the politeness of a true
woman. She took some roots from the
bag, roasted them in the fire, and gave
them to the men to eat. She gathered
up all her food, which was her chief
concern, owing to the famines she had
experienced, washed herself at the
spring, and followed the men cheerfully
to the boat. On being taken to Santa
Barbara she manifested great delight
on seeing the sights of civilization. She
became a universal favorite, and was
presented with many gifts. Passengers
on the Panama steamer that landed there
all wanted to see the lost woman of San
Nicolas. She related by signs her ex-
perience on the island, as she spoke a
language that none of the Indians
knew, and none of the Spanish fathers,
versed in Indian dialects, could under-
stand. Civilization, which prolongs the
life of some, shortened that of the wo-
man of San Nicolas. An excessive love
of fruit led to her death in Santa Bar-
bara, at the age of fifty. She was buried
with the honors of the Catholic Church
by the Franciscan Fathers, and her
dress and trinkets were sent to Rome
and placed in the receptacle of the
world's curiosities.

"The story of the lost woman of San
Nicolas will always remain a wonder-
ment. Her ingenuity is seen in the
pails she made of grass, made to hold
water by smearing them with melted
asphaltum, and in her bird-skin dresses,
her bone needles, her knife of iron hoop,
and the language she invented and
spoke. It is inexplicable to all who
have learned her story how a woman
could live eighteen years on an island
around which the waves were beating a
requiem to hope, getting her food, and
cooking it without even those facilities
which are common to the savage, and
making her dresses neatly without the
aid of needles except what she carved
out of bone. She laid aside one dress
for eighteen years, to be worn when the
white men should come, of which she
had a presentiment. She built her own
house, protected herself from the cold,
gained supreme control over the wild
beasts about her, and preserved her love
for men and women for well-nigh two
decades of human life alone in the wild.
With no previous knowledge of civiliza-
tion, solitude appeared to have educated
her for it. An ordinary woman would
have perished with despondency in such
a desolate, hungry, naked, hopeless out-
look."

Old residents of Turner, Me., say
that Solon Chase is a ship of the old
block. His father, for many years
known as "the Squire," was famed for
his sharp sayings. Jesse Drew, of Fort
Fairfield, used to live in Turner, and
was an opponent of the Squire in town
politics. He says that sailing upon
Solon's father one day just before town
meeting to talk over matters, the Squire
saluted him as follows: "Drew, sit
down and lie awhile!"

THOMAS KAY, President of the Stock-
port (Eng.) Natural History Society,
read a paper "On Making Sea Water
Potable." His process is to remove the
chlorides by the use of citrate of silver.
He says that one ounce of citrate of sil-
ver will convert half a pint of sea water
into a drinkable fluid, and a man can
keep alive on it a day, or seven ounces
will serve to sustain life for a week. He
proposes that bottles of the citrate of
silver should be secured in the lifeboats
of ships, and used when absolutely re-
quired. The citrate of soda formed is
an important constituent of the human
body, and citric acid, from its carbon, is
almost a food.

A Thunder Storm at a Circus.

"The rain at a circus the other night,"
said a gentleman, "reminds me of an
incident at a former circus. The rain
came down in torrents and the thunder
was terrific. A number of ladies began
to shriek. I begged them all to sit
down and be quiet, assuring them that
the storm would soon be over and warn-
ing them of the danger of a panic, in
which they would certainly be crushed
to death. They finally took their seats,
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WIT AND WISDOM.

MANY a man might have become fa-
mous, if he had not become known.

A NORFOLK man says there is more
enthusiasm to get rid of a minister than
to get a new one.

A SAFE robbery, we take it, is one
wherein the burglar manages to reach
Canada before the detectives reach him.

THE man who intends to camp out
next month should begin to prepare for
it by sleeping in the back yard and eat-
ing raw meats.

A CINCINNATI man is reported to have
robbed a summer hotel head waiter of
\$540. It is seldom that we hear of such a
marked case of retributive justice.

It is said that a factory in California
makes 250,000 gross of matches in a
year. This makes the Chicago divorce
judges feel rather discouraged at times.

THE bean has found a new enemy in
the bean weevil. Hitherto the worst
enemy of the beans has been the cook
who has mashed them into paste like
potatoes.

"No POLITICAL institution will alter
the nature of ignorance, or hinder it
from producing vice and misery. Let
ignorance start how it will, it must run
the same round of low appetites, poverty,
slavery, and superstition."

THERE are some whose minds have no
guest chamber. They regard hospitality
as a sin. They have taken in a set of
opinions—truths, they call them; truths
they may or may not be—and they have
no room for anything more.

THE Major (to nephew, who wants
taking down a bit, he thinks)—"What!
you here, Percy! Aint you rather
young to be going to balls?" Percy—
"What, and you here, too, uncle!
Why, I should have thought you'd
given up this kind of thing long ago!"
Punch.

Beyond a certain point, and that a
very low one, man cannot advance in the
invention of beauty without directly
imitating natural form. On the shapes
which are familiar in the world to the
eyes of men God has stamped those
characters of beauty which He has made
it man's nature to love.

"How did you get that awful cold?"

"I suspect I got it sitting by the win-
dow."

"You should be careful about
sitting by an open window at this time
of year."

"Oh, the window wasn't open.
It had just been washed, and it was so
clear and transparent that it seemed just
like sitting out of doors. Yes, that was
how I probably caught cold."

PHILOSOPHY.

Our fondest hopes are oft destroyed,
But why in tears bewail our plight?
The trouble that one can't avoid
A world of grieving won't set right.

Then do not walk the floor in woe
Because a note is overdue,
But let the man walk whom you owe—
He'll do enough of it for two.

—Boston Courier.

HOW IS THAT FOR EYE?—Priest—
"Tell me, Murphy, how came you by
that black eye! Were you fighting,
eh?" Murphy—"Well, indeed, I won't
deceive yer reverence. Mick O'Flaherty
and myself had a little difference; but
sure, if yer reverence only seen Mick's
eye, now, thro' you'd say there was
nothin' wrong with mine at all!"—
Judge.

It is claimed that a successful type-
setting machine has at last been put in
operation. This is likely to work con-
siderable hardship on the careless
editor who is in the habit of blaming his
mistakes on the compositor. He can't
discharge a \$5,000 machine every time
he makes a mistake unless he is a mil-
lionaire, and if he were a millionaire he
wouldn't be an editor.

We used to go botanizing once, says
the editor, and we discovered a pretty
plant in the course of our botanical
wanderings. We carefully analyzed it
and concluded that it was an overgrown
spoonful of saxifrage. But when our
hands swelled up so big that we
couldn't wash them without using a tub,
we concluded that we must have made a
mistake in the number of stamens and
that it was mercury and not saxifrage.

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